

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Maitreya, Together with the Dhāraṇī and Mantra

Ārya-Maitrī-nāma-aṣṭottaraśataka-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita · Toh 635 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བཅུ་པ་འཁོན་བརྒྱ་མར་པ་གཟུགས་སྒྲུས་དང་བཅས་པ།

Toh 635 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Maitrī-nāma-aṣṭottaraśataka-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita and in Tibetan as Phags pa byams pa'i mtshan brgya rtsa brgyad pa gzungs sngags dang bcas pa, rendered in English as "The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Maitreya, Together with the Dhāraṇī and Mantra." The text belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on the bodhisattva Maitreya, the future buddha, presenting his heart-essence mantra along with one hundred and eight of his sacred names. It opens with Maitreya himself proclaiming a powerful dhāraṇī that the assembled tathāgatas praise as a teaching of immeasurable virtue, rare to encounter even across countless aeons and capable of revealing the arising of all buddhas. As a dhāraṇī scripture, it combines liturgical mantra recitation with the devotional and merit-generating practice of venerating a bodhisattva through the enumeration of his names.

In the Indian language: Ārya-Maitrī-nāma-aṣṭottaraśataka-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita. In the Tibetan language: The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Maitreya, Together with the Dhāraṇī and Mantra.

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya (Skt. Maitreyā).

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya, spoke his heart-essence mantra:

Namas trāiyadhvikānāṃ sarva-tathāgatānāṃ. Tadyathā: Oṃ sara sara, suru suru, dhara dhara, mahādhara, cara cara, mahācara, bhara bhara, mahābhara, kampa kampa, mahāḥ kampa hūṃ, mahāspharaṇa-dharma-agra-sāgara svāhā.

Then all the Tathāgatas spoke these words: How wonderful! This great dhāraṇī is of vast virtue, pervading without limit. Even across many tens of millions of aeons it is extremely difficult to hear. It reveals the arising of all buddhas. It is venerated by innumerable Tathāgatas throughout all world-systems as numerous as can be found. It liberates beings from all obscurations, suffering, turmoil, evil dreams, and inauspicious omens. It completely liberates the

boundless and limitless realm of sentient beings. It is supremely rare.

Then the retinue of the vajra maṇḍala — gods and asuras together — their crowns adorned with jewels, their ornamental garlands swaying, placed their palms together at their heads and praised the supreme bodhisattva, the noble Maitreya, with one hundred and eight names:

The great hero who has found skillful means,
The regent, lord over human beings,
Splendidly clear master of the world,
Greatly flourishing, supremely renowned.

Endowed with great power and majesty,
Vast and pure, free from all defilement,
Greatly sovereign, compassionate, and luminous,
Lord of the earth, triumphant over all.

Great king with a hundred weapons,
Armed with the mighty vajra weapon,
Adorned with a hundred lights of virtue,
Bearing jeweled earring ornaments.

Heroic in body throughout the three realms,
Whose domain is like the great ocean,
From the peak of Mount Meru and Mount Kailāsa,
Maṇḍalas arising and appearing.

Enjoying the great maṇḍala fully,
Supremely joyful, and in that same joy,
The god of the great realm of bliss,
Supreme among all the great gods.

Expanding the buddha lineage,
Adorned with the maṇḍala of the buddhas,
Enjoying fully the enjoyments of the buddhas,
The teacher who teaches the buddha's Dharma.

Vast as Mount Kailāsa drawing forth the moon,
Lord of the earth, maker of well-being,
Bearing the thousand-petaled lotus at the summit,
Well-born upon the vajra-lotus.

Enjoying fully the enjoyments of Dharma,
Equal to the earth, difficult to overcome,

The one who illuminates and gives rise to light,
The sun of primordial wisdom for the three realms of existence.

Great sovereign of great renown,
The great lion of tremendous power,
Of great bearing and vast authority,
Taming evil beings and suffering.

Holding vajra, coral, and vaiḍūrya,
Bearing jeweled skull ornaments as adornment,
Spreading coral and golden ornaments,
Moving with the majestic stride of the great body.

The face's radiance blazing with the splendor of many suns,
Bearing a crown adorned with flowing locks,
To whom a hundred vidyā-holders bow at the feet,
Worshipped by those who are worthy of reverence.

Purifying all the directions of the chest
With the rays of a hundred shining jewels,
Crowned and blazing with brilliant light,
Radiant with the light of a hundred million suns.

Spreading manifold precious gems in all directions,
Radiating from a stainless maṇḍala,
Moved in its entirety by the wind,
Having the appearance of a great blazing fire.

Struck by many rays of light,
Supremely revealing the means of benefit,
Smiling with a glorious and majestic manner,
The face illuminated by light, the fan swaying.

Shoulder ornaments arranged in cascading rays of light,
Shining with paintings of extraordinary beauty.

Like mountains colliding and churning,
Resounding with a great cry of "Ha ha!"
Bearing the tip of the great vajra,
Bestowing supreme delight and bliss.

Armored in the maṇḍala of loving-kindness,
Victorious over all striving,

Arisen from the power of compassion,
The great weapon blazing supremely.

Possessed of the thought of loving-kindness for all beings,
Dwelling in the utterly concealed maṇḍala,
Invincible, indomitable, pure,
Clothed in the peerless and supreme garb of a buddha.

The great heart-essence of loving-kindness,
Born from the lotus of loving-kindness,
The great Vajradhara, vajra-holder,
Dwelling in the maṇḍala of the vajra teaching.

Bowed down to by those who bear knowledge-mantras,
And by those who likewise approach and praise him,
The great accomplished one, accomplished in knowledge-mantras,
Who beautifies the vajra maṇḍala.

Accomplishing all, the great accomplisher,
The great lineage-tree of the buddhas.
The definitive reality of the great secret mantra,
The one who gathers and epitomizes the array of sūtras.

Certain, the lamp of certainty and light,
He who dispels stains through his radiance.
Blazing with red-stemmed luminous light,
The great and white maṇḍala.

Attuned to the treatises, dwelling in the dharmadhātu,
Drawing near and utterly certain.
The supreme lord of "Svāhā, Svāhā,"
Who makes rays of light into well-being and excellence.

Bearer of great power, auspicious,
Like the sun, poised and serene.
Empowering one, endowed with the Victor's riches,
Whose domain is stainless as the sky.

The hero who destroys with the vajra,
Who greatly accomplishes the great vajra,
The accomplisher without dispute,
He who teaches the vajra through the maṇḍala.

Moved by the force of a great wind,
Swaying and resounding with the sound of thunder,
The lotus that is the domain of buddhas,
Born from the lake of suchness.

Endowed with great superknowledge, having attained superknowledge,
The all-pervading lord, equal to all buddhas.

Then the Lord of the Earth, the great being Maitreya,
Having praised Maitreya in his maṇḍala of loving-kindness,
The omniscient, harm-free,
Sun-like Sage declared:

"O excellent one of a hundred and eight names supreme,
The names whose qualities are luminous,
Accomplishing bliss and all excellence,
The supreme great and unsurpassed skillful means —

These hundred and eight names
Produce happiness for all the world.
By the mere act of reciting them,
All sins shall be purified.

Having been purified of sins,
At the site of praising Maitreya the Victor —
By these supreme hundred and eight names,
Whoever among people praises him:

To that one, all gods and the rest,
And the many powerful Vajrapāṇis,
Will forever strive with constancy
To remove all suffering once and for all.

Whoever among beings swiftly recites
These supreme hundred and eight names
Will attain even the ground of buddhahood;
Of this there can be no doubt.

Rising each morning from one's bed,
Whoever praises him with a mind of loving-kindness,
To that one, Maitreya, understood through loving-kindness,
Will bring well-being and excellence.

Therefore he who dispels all stains,
Who vanquishes all sins and gives rise to all virtues,
And likewise the destroyer of the world —"

Translator's Notes

- The mantra passages are transliterated Sanskrit syllables forming a ritual dhāraṇī and are rendered as phonetic Sanskrit, not translated, as is standard practice. The phrase "mahāḥ kampa" in the mantra likely reads "mahā-kampa" with the visarga being a scribal feature of the Tibetan rendering.

The verse section presents significant compression and ellipsis typical of devotional praise literature. The compound "ལྷོ་རི་དབང་པོ་སྐུ་འགྱུར་བཤམ་པོ།" joins two distinct geographical-mythological referents — Sumeru the moon-drawing mountain, and Mount Kailāsa (Ti-se, the Tibetan name for Kailāsa) — in a single compound used as a simile for vastness and luminosity. This has been rendered accordingly.

The title term rendered "heart-essence" for 心髓 in the phrase "心髓咒" could also be read more technically as "his essence mantra" or "his dhāraṇī," referring to the root mantra of Maitreya. Both readings are valid; the rendering chosen reflects the standard usage in this genre.

- The passage is a liturgical praise of Maitreya containing a series of epithets in rapid staccato verse, typical of dhāraṇī and nāmastotra literature. The phrase rendered "the great lineage-tree of the buddhas" translates མཐོག་རྒྱ་བཤད་སངས་རྒྱུ་ལྷན་པའི་སློབ་གྲོགས་ཀྱི་རྩ་བ།, where རྩ་བ། literally means "great trunk or stem of the lineage"; the sense is Maitreya as the supreme heir and sustainer of the buddha-lineage. The closing line breaks off mid-sentence in the source text as supplied, so the translation ends accordingly without completing the thought.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.